

p.323 makes point that strong front-*jer* is never umlauted by following back-*jer*, which he feels is strange if we imagine the Umlaut to be a pre-*Jer* Shift phenomenon. He toys with the idea that back-*jer* couldn't affect the Umlaut because it was *überkurz*, but he doesn't like this explanation because front-*jer* is also *überkurz* and therefore should be vulnerable to an equally *überkurz* back-*jer* (total bullshit reasoning).

p.324 Instead he offers up a *kaum nachzuweisende Theorie* about the front-*jer* carrying a "Hochton oder Nebenton" when followed by a back-*jer* syllable, which gave it a normal length (why?). He sums up with the obvious point that these non-umlauted (non-backed) front *jer*s are all in strong position and so end up as /e/, and since most likely this change has already occurred in the dialect underlying *Zogr.*, we are still no closer to a solution, because an Umlaut which only affects weak *jer*s presupposes the preservation of the weak-*jer*s, but in such a scenario there shouldn't yet have been a difference between weak and strong *jer*s. He doesn't talk about situations where a front *jer* is followed by a back-*jer* that itself is also followed by a *jer* (i.e. a still-weak *jer* that is followed by a back-*jer*), which I can find with the regex

[tʀps̥s̥dfgh̥jkl̥z̥x̥čvbn̥m̥k̥x̥g̥ž̥+][ʲtʀps̥s̥dfgh̥jkl̥z̥z̥x̥čvbn̥m̥k̥x̥g̥ž̥+][ʲtʀps̥s̥dfgh̥jkl̥z̥z̥x̥čvbn̥m̥k̥x̥g̥ž̥+][ʲʲ].

NB Leskien's claim that ь is never umlauted by ь is only true if you disregard the long-adj ы and ых endings, which strictly speaking are from *ьь and *ьихь, because you get multiple examples like *праведьньыхъ* <https://ocstexts.co.uk/texts?210012> and *жрьновьны* <https://ocstexts.co.uk/texts?237546> in *Zographensis*. This suggests that the *Jer* Umlaut, if it occurred at all, happened AFTER these long-form endings were reinterpreted as *-y and *ухь, which is something that must be a manuscript-specific innovation because the Kiev *Folia* scrupulously differentiates *ьь from *y by writing the former as <ы> and the latter as <ьи> (Gotteri 1973, Schaecken 1987:33-34)

p.324 Second thing Leskien says is that there are no instances of backing of [ʲ] after palatal consonants - this seems to be true when we search the regex

[čšžžh̥jln̥r̥][ʲtʀps̥s̥dfgh̥jkl̥z̥z̥x̥čvbn̥m̥k̥x̥g̥ž̥+][y̥Āu̯], though there are a few where the *jer* is dropped or indicated by a *pajerok* (*враждѣ, отрѣшѣ*)

p.324-5 Leskien says that the same inhibiting effect is carried by *following* soft-consonants, but he misses *дънесѣньбаро* <https://ocstexts.co.uk/texts?208298>, *сѣвазѣнь* < *сѣвѣзѣньĀ <https://ocstexts.co.uk/texts?214004>, and *вѣсждоу* <https://ocstexts.co.uk/texts?231745> and *отѣвѣсждѣ* <https://ocstexts.co.uk/texts?215699>

(perhaps because they written with *jat'* which he may have viewed as a front-vowel, despite its etymology)

p.325 Leskien draws the conclusion from the above that the Umlaut's "Wirkung nicht unmittelbar vom Vokal der folgenden Silbe ausgeht, sondern von dem durch ihn beeinflussten vorangehenden Consonanten, z.b. *вѣръна* kann entstehen, weil das *н* hart bleibt, *вѣръни* bleibt, weil das *н* durch *и* erweicht ist", though he maintains that this Erweichung did not possess "denselben Grad der Stärke wie die der altererbten palatalen Consonanten". This is unsatisfactory from a phonological point of view: this mooted weaker palatalisation before front-vowels in *Zogr.* either was phonological or it wasn't, and if it wasn't then it can't have had any different effect on preceding vowels to that of its autophonemic hard ausgesprochenen Gegenstücken.

p.327-8 ь werde similarly never umlauted in strong-position

p.328 moots a ridiculous idea that when followed by complicated clusters that would form difficult combinations with the consonant preceding a weak ъ if the latter fell, the jer is given a "grössere Fülle und damit Widerstandsfähigkeit gegen den Umlaut", e.g. дѣждити.

p.329-330 explains lack of въ > вѣ before jotted vowels and и by Dehnung, i.e. völlig im Einklang mit der Trubetzkoy'schen Theorie der /ъ,y/ Archiphoneme

p.332 remarks on lack of fronting of къ and сѣ, which he at first considers a possible consequence of the impossibility of secondarily-palatalised /k'/ due to its absence in native words before front-vowels, but then he rejects that idea because s- has no such restriction [JW: though he neglects to mention that the potential opposition /s/:/s'/ may have still existed between, say, вси /v'si/ and сила /sila/, and therefore plain /s/ even before front-vowels may have been paradigmatically hard in the same way as /k/], and because /k'/ "konnte sich ja im gegebenen Falle sekundär entwickeln, wie z.B. in Fremdwörtern, кѣсарь u. dgl."

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p.333 rejects a backing of *ъ caused by following *ъ due to the preponderance of <e> spellings
p.333 explicitly rejects Totomanova's merger-theory by calling cases like -шѣдѣ "weiter nichts als Fehler"

p.333-4 claims that <ъ> is erhalten after *í ñ í, but the data seien less clear for other palatals

p.334 claims that ѣ is bewahrt before *í ñ í

p.335 claims that adj. *ън- groups have backing most of the time before back-vowels but not front-vowels unless ч ж шт жд vorangehen, and says that this comports with Zogr. and suggests a common Vorlage.

p.335-6 says that conversely, after ч ж etc. ѣн- even before front-vowels is "in ausserordentlicher Uebersahl eingetreten"

p.336 bottom: word-final *ъ shows the same difference between tendency to keep <ъ> after *í ñ í but not other palatals [JW: couldn't this be a case of needing to signal the palatality of /í ñ í/ with the vowel-letter, which isn't needed for the others? Same as how Mid. Bg. tends to use <ж> only after /j š ž/ etc.?)

p.337 top: mentions that <ръ\$> spellings from *ръ could be excluded from the above-mentioned tendency to keep <ъ> after *í ñ í because it may reflect real hardening of *í [JW: though Mar. shows considerably less unambiguous evidence for hardened *í than Supr. or even Zogr: searching for *í[Æuq] turns up only гороушѣноу <*gořušnu <https://ocstexts.co.uk/texts?7741>, творж <https://ocstexts.co.uk/texts?51049> and кесара <*késarǣ <https://ocstexts.co.uk/texts?59650>, whereas Zogr. has 15X examples and Supr. has them all over the place]

p.337: Leskien assumes that the "grosser Uebergewicht" of word-final <ъ> after <ч ж шт жд ц s> reflects a real hardening of the consonants: "Es sind also diese Consonanten für den Schreiber oder einen seiner Vorlage hart, daher das ѣ". This is a big jump and directly contradicts the Totomanova'schen Theorie.

-back-jer after these palatals "bildet einen starken Gegensatz gegen den Zographensis, der sie gar nicht hat."

p.337 bottom: looks at old i-stems and finds that they keep <ъ> after *čšžhŋ more often, which Leskien puts down to a tradition that was "aware that these words belong to a certain grammatical category".

p.338 contrasts *ъsk- which he says in Zographensis is never backed by following back-vowel, with Marianus' treatment which has ѡск before back-vowels nearly three times as much as ѡск.

p.338 bottom: before <ц> Leskien explains the "größte Schwanken zwischen ѡ und ѡ" regardless of following vowel by the "Entpalatalisierung des ц, wodurch die so anlautende Silbe hart wurde".

p.339 mentions the overwhelming use of unetymological ѡ in the infinitive-stems of бѣрати дѣрати пѣрати стѣлати зѣдати, and considers the front-jer versions "keine Alterthümlichkeit, sondern eine Abirrung des Schreibers". Thus he is implicitly assuming that some backing occurred before the dawn of written OCS and led to the back-versions being seen as correct

p.339 summarises conclusions about Zogr. and Mar. regarding backing of *ѡ

p.340 says that Marianus behaves like Zogr. in showing very little fronting of ѡ in кѡ сѡ groups

p.342 sums up the data of various other odds and ends by concluding that Zogr. and Mar. both have fronting of ѡ in дѣвѣ зѣли вѣнѣ бѣдѣти etc., but Zogr. is more consistent, whereas Mar. is consistent only with вѣнѣ and бѣдѣти

p.343-344 makes the point that in Mar. you never get spellings like *ве дни, suggesting that no real fronting of the jer in strong position could have occurred, despite more frequent spellings like въ днѣхъ in Mar. than in Zogr. Instead Mar. only ever shows vocalisation with <о>, e.g. во вѣсеи, возьми.

p.344 Leskien thus concludes that the Vorlage of both Zogr. and Mar. had no fronting of strong back-jer by following weak front-jer.

p.345 remarks on the difference between Mar. and Zogr. in the *ѡм- verbal-root, which Zographensis actually spells back-jer even before front-vowels, but where Mar. tends to show jer-umlaut mostly before back-syllables

p.345 bottom: Leskien notes that up to now he has been imagining that these jer-umlauts occurred in some Vorlage at a time when the weak jers were still pronounced, but that he now wants to try a new theory, namely one where the spellings stem from a time when the jers had already fallen and instead reflect changes in the vorangehenden consonants.

p.345-6 Leskien uses the discrepancy in Zogr. between exceptionless зѣд- for *зѣдати vs пс/п'с/сп/с'п for *рѣсати to argue that, because /zd/ is an accepted cluster even in pre-Jer Shift times, whereas /ps-/ is not, the /zd-/ resulting from the fallen jer in *зѣдати would cause no pronunciation problems, but the /ps-/ would, hence it occasionally gets metathesised. He says we should expect at least some **пѣсати spellings if the jer-umlaut-spellings occurred with still-existing jers and affected *зѣда and *рѣса equally.

p.346 Leskien advances the theory that *рѣса- root in the Zogr. scribe's living language had been everywhere replaced with *писа- [JW: Mar. has only 3X spellings of the zero-grade *рѣса- stem left, all with no jer: писано, писно, and написати, but Zogr. has loads and according to my autoreconstruction conversely only has 3X unetymological *пис roots (написати and 2X писалше), so this reasoning of Leskien's is a stretch], and the scribe didn't pronounce weak jers so viewed the пѣс/пѣс spellings of his Vorlage as conveying /ps-/ which was an alien cluster to his language, so he "merzte es daher aus und schrieb überall das von ihm so gelesene писати"

p.347 - illegal jers in the full-grade-stems of the *merti/*kolti/*borti etc. verbs (оумърѣти etc.) stem also from this view of weak jer-spellings as being silent [JW: though here of course the present-stem zero-grade spellings will have strengthened the feeling that мър- etc. is how all forms of these verbs should start]

p.347-8 Leskien then explains that the apparent instances of Jer Umlaut could instead just reflect secondary palatalisation-assimilations, i.e. he assumes that in a word like *věrni the /r/ and /n/ were secondarily-soft, whereas in *věrna only the /r/ was, so when the weak intervening jer fell out, you got an assimilation of this secondary-palatalisation to the nature of the second consonant, hence /věr'n'i/ but /věrna/, and the writing of <ь> vs <ъ> reflects the soft/hard nature of the /r/.

p.348 In the same way he explains why only strong ь wirkt umlautend auf vorangehenden vokalen: *въ днь > /v'd'en'/, but *въ дње > /vo dn'e/. [JW: here he doesn't explain why the d isn't softened by consonant-soft-assimilation]

- lack of umlaut after *k, *s erklärt er damit, dass diese Konsonanten immer hart bleiben, auch wenn sie in Konsonantgruppen vorkommen, derer der zweiter Bestandtheil weich ist. Here he has to do some adhoc reasoning to explain въ слѣдъ by drawing a distinction between LCS *slě > /s'l'ě/ in слѣдъ and neuentstandenen /sl/-Gruppen < *sълě- > /s'l'ě/ in сълѣсти etc. In слѣдъ, he says, “stand die Lautgruppe c + Consonant von jeher zusammen, während bei dem Ausfall von ъ nach к, с solche Gruppen sekundär entstanden sind, und die Gruppenpalatalisirung später nicht mehr einzutreten braucht.”

p.348-9 Leskien finishes by claiming that weak ъ is really only fronted in Zogr. after /b v z d/, and thus that clusters of these sounds "+ Consonanten waren erweichbar". p.349 he then uses this to explain the Erhaltung in Zogr. of тъмѣ възъмѣте сънѣмиште: because /tm'/ /zm'/ and /nm'/ were conversely not subject to group-cluster-softness-assimilation.